A SERIOUS SPORTS PAGE

12/17/25

NEWS FROM A SERIOUS FOOTBALL LEAGUE

ISSUE 33

NO GIRLS ALLOWED

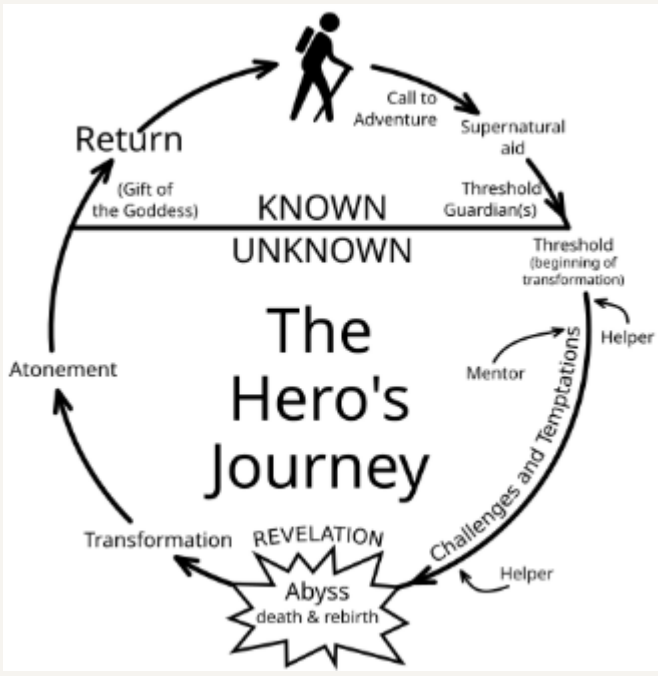
SUNNY DAY CHUCK DOWNFIELD

In the ASFL's inaugural season, the managers of both championship teams were women (Melanie Shayer and Kaitlyn Vasey). However, this year that glass ceiling has been shattered. Men are finding more success than ever before as ASFL managers, and this year's playoffs are no longer dominated by women. With Mallory DeSantiago's team Malpal's Boytoys eliminated from the post-season this week, all four remaining managers are men, meaning the championship matchup is guaranteed to be the opposite of last year. This fact has not gone unnoticed by the four managers still in contention for the championship. "It's an honor to have a chance at being the first man to win the ASFL championship," said Sam Shayer in a press conference yesterday. "I hope my success inspires young men across the country, and makes them believe that they can also grow up to be ASFL managers no matter what anybody says." Gundy Night Football manager Daniel Tribble had similar feelings to share. "I'm really proud to be part of such a major breakthrough for our sport, and I know my old man would be proud to see how far we've come." Tribble forgot that his father is still alive, and is also managing the team that hopes to defeat him in the semifinals.

THE HERO'S JOURNEY

In the classic monomyth plot structure "The Hero's Journey," the protagonist enters an unfamiliar land and faces various trials and obstacles. At some point they reach their "belly of the whale" moment, sometimes called "abyss," where they undergo some kind of symbolic death and rebirth or transformation that changes them and prepares them for the rest of the journey. That sounds an awful lot like the moment Dawn's Early Lightnings became statistically eliminated from playoff contention, because it's been almost all uphill from there. Manager Dawn Burney's goal is to run the table in the loser's bracket and finish in 7th place in the league.

Surely all of us are rooting for it at this point, right?

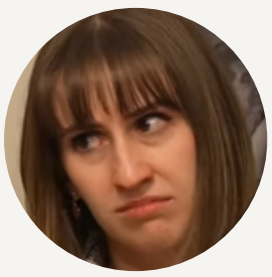


Featured Doubleheader: WET vs AHL & 4D vs JF

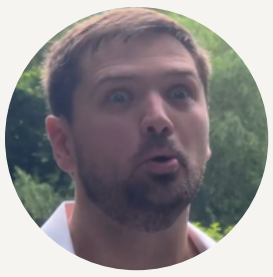
This week's semifinals matchups will feature the top two ranked teams from the regular season (Coren's Wet Supermen and Gundy Night Football) taking on two challengers (All Hope Is Lost and Jasmine's Fav) after enjoying a bye week. Three of these teams have on average been the three highest-scoring teams so far this season, and the fourth team is managed by Alan Tribble. Despite the lack of statistical credentials, Alan believes his team belongs among the heavy hitters. "My boys are conditioned to perform in the low-oxygen air of Denver, so they'll come out on top this week and next."

Noteworthies

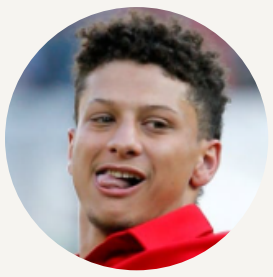
Baller of the Week: WR Amon-Ra St. Brown (SMEL), 41.4 pts
Another thrilling performance from star wide receiver Amon-Ra St. Brown propelled Smelly Team That Smells Smelly to the top of the loser's bracket. "I'm a lot of things," St. Brown said in a post-game interview, "For example, I'm a picker, I'm a grinner, I'm a lover, and I'm a sinner, but I ain't no quitter." No one followed up to determine if St. Brown is also a midnight toker.



Walloping of the Week: Jasmine's Fav defeats Malpal's Boytoys
Editor's Note: Alan Tribble's team Jasmine's Fav took care of business against Malpal's Boytoys, winning by a convincing 41-point margin to advance in the playoffs. They did not face Sam Shayer's team All Hope Is Lost, as we incorrectly wrote in this section last week. Budget cuts here at ASS Page have led to declining editorial standards. We apologize for the error!



Nailbiter of the Week: The Girly Pops defeat The Burney Bakery
After narrowly missing the playoffs due to a tiebreaker, The Burney Bakery's fortunes have continued to trend downward this week as they narrowly lost to The Girly Pops in the loser's bracket. "It's happening again... I can feel it," said manager Kris Burney cryptically on his way to the locker room. Next, Kris's team will rematch his wife Dawn, which will probably turn out fine.



Injury News of the Week: QB Patrick Mahomes (MPBT) tears his ACL
"Patrick Mahomes is dead to me," was the quote that shocked the league this week. The face of Malpal's Boytoys tore his ACL in a failed attempt to save his team's season. Mallory DeSantiago wants nothing to do with him any more. Mahomes was pushed off the team bus somewhere in Texas, where he will start to rehab and look for a new team next season.

Playoff Bracket

Round 1 (Wk 15)

(5) Disc Golf Lazarus
vs
(4) All Hope Is Lost

(6) Malpal's Boytoys
vs
(3) Jasmine's Fav

BYE

(8) The Girly Pops
vs
(7) Burney Bakery

(10) Smelly Team
vs
(9) Nova & the Krons

(12) Early Lightnings
vs
(11) Max the Manx

Round 2 (Wk 16)

(1) Wet Supermen
vs
(4) All Hope Is Lost

(3) Jasmine's Fav
vs
(2) Gundy Night

(6) Malpal's Boytoys
vs
(5) Disc Golf Lazarus

(10) Smelly Team
vs
(8) The Girly Pops

(12) Early Lightnings
vs
(7) Burney Bakery

(11) Max the Manx
vs
(9) Nova & the Krons

Round 3 (Wk 17)

Winner of WET/AHL
CHAMPIONSHIP
Winner of JF/4D

Loser of WET/AHL
CONSOLATION GAME
Loser of JF/4D

??? → **Maybe Mal and Matt just play each other again? Scientists are unsure**

Winner of SMEL/GPOP
vs
Winner of DEB/BAKE

Loser of SMEL/GPOP
vs
Winner of M/NTK

Loser of DEB/BAKE
vs
Loser of M/NTK